

However, the second security breach discovered a day later, showed that even unrooted phones were in danger. This time, the method was foolproof. All the user had to do to enable Google Wallet was reset the data under the app settings, which would prompt him to enter a new PIN without asking for the old PIN. After wiping the old data, this new bypass allowed the user to link the account to a Google Prepaid Card, which then provided access to all previously available funds. The phone was as good as a cashier not asking to see your ID when you pay with credit card.

The safest way for Google to save your PIN is to secure it via the NFC chip, which requires action from your banks. While the two parties sort out new terms of service, there are several things you can do to keep your phone safe. This is what we're going to tell you about in this chapter.

Step 1: Enable password protection

The easiest way to secure your smartphone is with a password, making it the best place to start. We're going to concentrate on the more popular mobile operating systems and how their password (or password-like) security works.

► iOS

It's very easy to set a passcode on iOS, but it's no more secure than a PIN number. Fortunately, if you're running iOS4 or higher you can set a password instead. To set your iOS password or passcode, open the Settings app. From there, go to **General > Passcode Lock > Turn it on** and enter your new password or passcode.

► Android

Android's additional security comes in the form of a swipe pattern (unless you're running Android 2.2 Froyo, in which case you can also set a PIN or password). To set one, go to **Settings > Security > Change Unlock Pattern > Require Pattern**. You'll be able to enter a swipe pattern. Coming up with something easy won't do much to help, so figure out a complex swipe pattern you can remember.

► Windows Phone 7

In Windows Phone 7, you're able to set a lock screen password. To do this, flick left to go to **Settings > Lock & Wallpaper > turn on Password**. You'll be prompted to enter a new password twice. Do this and press "Done" to save your changes.